

INDIAN CINEMA, FILM INSTITUTIONS AND AWARDS

Indian Art and Culture Topic 15 - corrected conceptual spine - checked 6 Sep 2026

1. MEDIUM AND FORM

- Cinema = story + performance + image + sound + editing + mass circulation
- Film language: cinematography, mise-en-scene, editing, sound
- Documentary is framed non-fiction; animation is full cinema
- Cinema is not reducible to theatre or celebrity culture

2. CHRONOLOGY

- 1896 Lumiere in Bombay; 1897 first Indian-shot film; 1899 Save Dada
- 1913 Raja Harishchandra; 1917 Lanka Dahan; 1926 Fatma Begum
- 1931 Alam-Ara; 1933 Sairandhri; 1937 Kisan Kanya and Naujawan; 1939 Premnagar
- Late 1940s onward: parallel cinema and social realism

3. SOCIETY AND REGION

- Cinema shaped post-independence identity and empathy
- Representation is evidence with limits, not a social census
- Indian cinema is multilingual by structure; dubbed films need fresh certificates
- Digital / OTT expansion should be discussed conceptually, not through unsourced figures

4. REGULATION

- Cinematograph Act 1952 and CBFC under MB
- Certification for public exhibition, but cuts / refusal powers matter
- Current caution: do not present FCAT as a live current tribunal
- Cable TV regulation is separate from CBFC certification

5. INSTITUTIONS BY FUNCTION

- MB = policy anchor; CBFC = certification
- FTII and SRFTI = training institutions
- NFAI legacy / NFHM / NFDC-linked framework = archive and preservation
- NFDC = development plus consolidated public film architecture
- IFFI = festival; National Film Awards and Dadasaheb Phalke Award = recognition

6. CURRENT STATUS

First National Film Awards for 2024 announced in July 2025
Current officially announced Dadasaheb Phalke Award: Mahanand for second year 2024
Latest completed IFFI edition 2024 in Goa; IFFI official site live for Year 2025
Warning: BAFTA's Cinemasia & Pandya Film Festival are Dadasaheb award without official Academy confirmation

7. PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

- Keep category, director, milestone and institution separate.
- Boong question = BAFTA category + Lakshmi Priya Devi + limited first-claim.
- Withhold the option letter because the only locally held 2026 key is provisional.
- Best mains route: medium -> chronology -> regulation/institutions -> social role -> current caution.